

AJ Villalobos

Senior Rails Engineer | AI Application & Workflow Automation

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Profile

Senior Ruby on Rails engineer with 10 years shipping production web apps, APIs, and data-heavy business workflows across fintech, healthtech, and SaaS. Pragmatic builder who turns ambiguous requirements into reliable software – now applying that same instinct to AI-assisted development, using tools like Claude Code to ship faster without cutting corners on production quality. Also running a small software studio end-to-end as a founder, from customer problem to shipped product.

Core Strengths

Backend/Product	Ruby on Rails, API design, service objects, background jobs, PostgreSQL, Sidekiq, legacy modernization, product scoping
AI-Adjacent	AI-assisted development (Claude Code, agentic coding workflows), workflow automation, evaluation-minded tooling, prompt-driven iteration, human-in-the-loop internal tools
Frontend	TypeScript, JavaScript, Vue, Preact, Ember, Angular, HTML/CSS, mobile-friendly UX improvements
Systems	AWS, Heroku, integrations, webhooks, POS APIs, remittance workflows, audit trails, compliance-oriented business software

Experience

Lavanda	Oct 2025 – Present
Senior Ruby on Rails Developer	United Kingdom

- Ship features for Lavanda’s PMS and bookings product (Rails, GraphQL, Next.js) used by build-to-rent, co-living, and multifamily operators to run leasing and short-stay bookings from one system.
- Maintain and extend the existing DocuSign integration for lease and booking signing (e.g. Sender Fields), plus booking-import tooling for new-client data migration.
- Applies AI-assisted development day to day: Claude Code harness engineering, custom skills, self-verifying agent loops, and parallel agents via git worktrees.

Arqen	Jan 2026 – Present
Founder	Iloilo, Philippines

- Building a small software studio serving Philippine SMEs with operational tools for inventory, payroll, and compliance-heavy workflows.
- Developing KeepTrack.ph for inventory management and Timekeep.ph for payroll with local government compliance requirements.
- Using AI-assisted development (Claude Code, agentic coding workflows) to increase solo-founder shipping speed while holding to production-quality standards.

ShiftCare	May 2024 – Oct 2025
Ruby on Rails Engineer	Sydney, Australia

- Delivered features for both customer-facing and internal aged-care workflows using Rails APIs and Vue, balancing usability with maintainable backend architecture.

Radiopaedia.org	Jun 2023 – Jan 2024
Ruby on Rails Developer	Australia

- Improved mobile UX and key page layouts in a Rails application with TypeScript and Preact components.
- Focused on frontend-heavy improvements while integrating cleanly with Rails API behavior.

Kangarootime	Jul 2019 – May 2023
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- Maintained and extended a legacy childcare-center platform used across the United States.
- Refactored a significant status-tracking model to streamline how centers identify child status and unlock future feature work.
- Built COVID-related screening and onboarding features that helped centers adapt daily operations during a high-change period.

BloomSolutions

Nov 2017 – Dec 2020

Software Engineer

Makati, Philippines

- Built features for BloomRemit, a cryptocurrency-enabled remittance platform that facilitated over \$120M in customer transactions, with an emphasis on tested, maintainable service patterns.
- Led design work for BloomICO and BloomTeller, including wireframes, user flows, and scalable UI approaches.

Tanda

Jun 2017 – Jan 2018

Software Developer

Philippines

- Built third-party integrations around the core workforce product using multiple POS APIs.
- Created sales productivity tools that connected multiple apps, synchronized data, and automated team notifications via webhooks.
- Extended product workflows outside the main platform through a Facebook Messenger bot.

Aelogica

Jun 2016 – Jun 2017

Software Developer

Taguig, Philippines

- Developed backend systems for apartment and self-storage booking platforms using Rails, PostgreSQL, Sidekiq, AWS, and service-oriented patterns.
- Built internal applications and private Ruby gems distributed through a private RubyGems-style system.

Selected Projects

KeepTrack.ph

Inventory management

Inventory system for Philippine SMEs, informed by prior work building inventory and access-control tools for specialty coffee and medical laboratory operations. Focuses on stock movement, reporting, low-stock alerts, costing, and operational visibility.

Timekeep.ph

Payroll and compliance

Payroll product aimed at Philippine SMEs with local government compliance requirements built into the workflow.

Privacy-Focused Marketing Tool

Acquired side project

Built a simple privacy-first Bitly alternative focused on GDPR compliance; launched as a paid product and later acquired by an early user.

Clover Ruby Gem

Open source integration

Created an open-source Ruby wrapper for a major POS system REST API; the archived gem was forked and used in production integrations.

Earlier Experience

Proudcloud, Software Developer

Aug 2015 – Feb 2016

Worked across Rails API and Ember during a migration from a Rails monolith to a SPA used by companies connecting artists with production studios.

YouSource, Software Developer

Sep 2014 – Aug 2015

Developed Rails features for Cloudhealth, a pre-employment workflow platform; helped migrate frontend work toward Angular backed by Rails APIs.

Education

John B. Lacson Foundation Maritime University, Iloilo City

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology, Web Development

2010 – 2013